

Name: _____

Date: _____

LEARNING TARGET

I can use sentence and paragraph clues to determine the meaning of an unknown word.

KEY STRATEGY + WORKED EXAMPLE

Look for definitions, examples, contrasts, and cause-and-effect clues. Replace the word with your meaning and reread.

The trail was narrow, unlike the wide road. Contrast clue: narrow means not wide.

A. TRY TOGETHER - USE THE STRATEGY

1. Clue type: 'nocturnal, or active at night'
2. Clue type: 'fragile, unlike the sturdy box'
3. Meaning of narrow in the example.
4. Why should you reread after choosing a meaning?

B. CORE PRACTICE - SHOW YOUR WORK

5. The puppy was timid; it hid behind the chair when visitors arrived.

6. Meaning of timid.

7. Which words are the strongest clue?

8. The pond was murky, so we could not see the bottom.

9. Meaning of murky.

10. Name the cause-and-effect clue.

11. A habitat is the natural home of a plant or animal.

12. Meaning of habitat.

C. INDEPENDENT FLUENCY - CALCULATE AND CHECK

13. Clue type for habitat sentence.

14. The enormous whale was much larger than our boat. Meaning of enormous.

15. The room was vacant; no person or furniture was inside. Meaning of vacant.

16. The cheerful crowd smiled, laughed, and clapped. Meaning of cheerful.

17. Write a synonym for timid.

18. Write an antonym for enormous.

19. Use murky correctly in a new sentence.

20. Add a context clue to: The metal was malleable.

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D. APPLY THE SKILL

21. Explain how the puppy's action reveals timid.

22. Could murky mean deep? Use the sentence to justify your answer.

23. Write two sentences that teach the meaning of scarce without defining it directly.

E. REASON, CHECK AND CORRECT

24. Why can a dictionary's first definition be wrong for a sentence?

25. Describe the replace-and-reread check.

EXIT TICKET + CHALLENGE

26. Determine fragile in: Handle the fragile glass gently so it will not break.

Challenge: Write a four-sentence paragraph containing one challenging word and at least two useful context clues.

F. STUDENT REVIEW - SHOW WHAT YOU UNDERSTAND

Use your own words so your teacher can see what you understand and what to practise next.

27. Explain one strategy you used today.

28. Check one answer in a different way.

29. Circle one: I understand it | I need more practice | I need help

30. The easiest part was: _____

31. The most difficult part was: _____

Why was it difficult? _____

32. My next practice step is: _____

TEACHER COPY - ANSWERS AND SUPPORT

ANSWER KEY

A. 1) definition/restatement. 2) contrast. 3) not wide. 4) To check that the meaning fits the sentence. 5) source sentence. 6) shy/fearful. 7) hid behind chair when visitors arrived. 8) source sentence. 9) cloudy/not clear. 10) could not see bottom. 11) source sentence. 12) natural home. 13) definition. 14) very large. 15) empty. 16) happy/joyful. 17) shy. 18) tiny/small. 19-20) Answers vary; context must support meaning.

B. 21) Hiding from visitors shows fear or shyness. 22) No; the clue describes inability to see through the water, not depth. 23) Answers vary; clues should imply not plentiful.

C. 24) Words have multiple meanings; context selects the correct one. 25) Substitute the meaning and see whether the sentence still makes sense.

D. 26) easily broken.

Challenge: Answers vary. Check that the student's example follows every condition and that the reasoning is mathematically correct.

F. 27-28) Answers vary. Look for a clear strategy and a valid second check. 29-32) Use the reflection to identify confidence, difficulty and the next teaching step.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

Students may guess from one nearby word. Require them to identify the clue and verify the meaning in the full sentence.

TEACHER CHECK

- ☐ Uses an appropriate Grade 3 ELA strategy.
- ☐ Shows or explains thinking clearly.
- ☐ Checks a response using evidence, a rule, or a second method.
- ☐ Identifies a specific difficulty and useful next practice step.

PARENT / TEACHER TIP

Ask the child to explain how they know, not only state an answer. Have them point to the text evidence or language rule, then revise one response aloud.

NEXT STEP

Revisit the item the child marked difficult. Model one example, solve one together, then ask the child to complete one independently and explain the strategy.